

HST103

Mark Distribution

Quiz - 2 (both ^{will be} counted) 15 marks each → 30 mark
Assignment - 1 (After mid) - 10
Mid - 20
Final - 30
Presentation - 5
Attendance - 5

History is records of actions and thoughts of people in the past. It is not just the information but also interpretation. History is also a process of cause and effect. There is a succession in history. It is about continuity. History is also dominated by politics. Politics is only ^{one} aspect of human life. History is politics focusing on politics gives narrow picture of past. Politics is practised by a small group of people & the majority of people is being left out. This is

called exclusive approach.

The reasons behind politics gets more attention in history -

1. Methodological limitation - Written record
नामिका, ~~of~~ ^{by} In the past, educated
ruling class have written about themselves

2. Lack of objectivity of the historians -

Usually historians write history from the
pa fund given by the government. As a
result, history tend to glorify a particular
people, gender, community, class, party (political).

But the inclusive approach don't just focus
on politics. It tries to includes the other
aspects of human life and add as
people as possible. Complete picture of
history.

1. Exclusive Vs Inclusive &

2. 6 elements of inclusive approach.

3. Geography and environment

4. Profile of the rulers

5. Faith practise and believe

6. Medieval period, central asian rule in Bengal

7. Syncretism (mixing) is medieval period

8. Famine

9. Permanent settlement

10. Peasant resistance

11. Rise of the muslim middle class

job holder

12. Partition of Bengal - 1905

13. Road to partition 1947

14. Road to Bangladesh

15. 1971 in village and, women and other vulnerable

Proof

16. Conflict framework of 1971

Bangladesh War



Informal War

HST-103

class 2

History is a record of many aspects of human life. But most history usually focuses on political history. Politics is ^{the} formal and official part of state making. It's mostly focuses on activities of small group of ruling class ^{leaving} out the majority of the people. Such approaches are called - exclusive approach. Politics is a significant part but it is a part only & it's practised by small group of people. So, it becomes partial history where rulers, ruling class government officials, educated, elite group of people. So, the study of history remains incomplete.

But our approach is going to be the inclusive approach where we look at ^{the} past through as many angles as possible and study as many as people as possible. We do not

ignore politics but we will try to include as many as people as possible.

^{The}
(01) Environment - Bangladesh is the largest delta ^{like} shaped by Himalaya mountain with rivers, Brahmaputra, Meghna, and the Bay of Bengal that pulling the rivers to southward. So, the land is warm, flat, muddy and wet. Climate is moonsoon climate (Based on food production there are 2 types of civilization in the world. 1. Wet/Rice civilization: China, Bhutan, Indonesia, Vietnam, Cambodia, Nepal. 2. Wheat civilization / Dry civilization: Central Asia, India, Pakistan.

The settlers are coming here from wet civilization. But the invaders are coming from the wet/dry civilization. So Bengal becomes the transit point of two civilization.

Bangladesh is an active delta. Villages in chaur region like Jamulpur, Sirajganj are washed away and rebuilt again and again. The entire

It is not
just the
survival

community have learned to read ^{signs} science
of emotion and relocate before the
disaster. Ecological knowledge that pass
onto generation. ✓

Floods are the friends and enemies.

Farmers plant 'Boro' rice on winter.

They harvest the crops in April. For six
months the land is under water for
10-15 feet. Fish multiply and ecosystem
resets. ✓

The Sundarbans, the largest Mangrove
forest. It creates a lots of sources of
livelihood - honey, timber, coastal fishes
for coastal communities and also
existence of Bonobibi. ✓

2. The people / Ethnic Identity:

We are mixed. We are not a single race. We are crossroads. Over thousand of years, waves of people arrive. The first one is the Mongoloids coming from South-East Asia. They are attracted to wet land. Then Austro Negritos mixing together. Some followed trade routes and some followed armies - Aryans later on Turk Afghans. They intermarried, stayed and became us.

3. Livelihood : challenges & responses:

Every civilizations needs to grow. Bengal is a fertile land, ~~agri~~ one of the most agriculturally productive zone on South-East Asia. So, it attracted invaders. At the same time, flood destroyed the crops and riches the soil. The rivers carries ~~load~~ goods & also carried armies. Livelihood is never simple. It's always negotiation between abundance

& subtle vulnerability. So, people response to challenges through innovation, migration, community and resilience.

Example - ~~Muslim~~ trade. The wavers of Muslim

Dhaka particularly Dhamrai & Sonargaon they could produce a fine cotton that is called running water. It is produced by generational knowledge and perfect humidity and fine cotton produced by the river of Brahmaputra. British Colonial policy destroy the local industry and flooded the market with Manchester cotton livelihood of ~~to~~ ~~to~~ destroyed overnight.

4. Social and community structures:

Bengal society is built from bottom up (নিচ থেকে উপরে, lower to upper) by farmers, fishers and families — any king or government. সমাজ system. Premodern Bengal was the real government. Any disputes was sorted in the পঞ্চায়েত & let by village elders. Inheritance of land, marriage is decided by 'somaj'. Festivals are arranged by সমাজ. So, for majority people who never saw a king, 'সমাজ' was the government.

- ① What are the main geographical features of East Bengal/ What makes East Bengal geographically unique? — Same Answer.
- ② Discuss how environment & nature influenced socio-economic, cultural lives of East Bengalis with examples.

2 Ta Article ~~২৬০~~ ২৬১ for 2 Questions.

② Answer :

Since East Bengal has moonsoon of climate & crops and livelihood depends of farming, fishing and weaving. Naturally it makes us a believers of absolute power.

The concept of Kali & Durga represents the omnipotence of nature. In everyday economic activities we remember God and Goddesses for safety and well-being.

para, For example, the water is the single most ecological element of culture of Bengal.

People call Ganga ma, Durga ma because of the

providing nature. So, fisherman remember ~~was~~
ganga for getting fish. Dipping in
water to wash your sins away is very
common. For example - Langalband, a place
near (traditional Dipping) signifies the spiritual
connection in nature.

Emergence of Islam, specifically 'Sufi' variant
also ~~to~~ stabilised connection with nature in
Bengal. For ex - The local God & Goddess got
mixed with the lives of 'Sufis'. For ex - Remember
Badar Pir in the ~~name~~ ^{place} of local God &
Goddesses during sailing across the ~~sea~~ river.
Muslim fisherman arranges milad offers
'sirni' or donation to Darga before their first
voyage of the season. Local myth got Islamic
flavour later on. For example - 'Khaja Khaji'
a local pir known as water saint. It is
believed that he is so old that he even met
Prophet Noah.

influence health.
Nature also ~~help~~ our diseases and ~~disease~~
Now, William Twinning, an English
medical practitioner mentioned that
people generally exposed to extreme heat
in Bangla suffers from inflammatory
fever, cholera, paralysis, apoplexy.

Common people the villagers avoid going out
or travelling too far in Bhadra month.

~~The~~ Villagers usually choose drier &
cooler season for wedding. so, it's
easier for grooms party to travel
Brides house.

Traditional
~~Dressing up~~ - Attire - is environmentally inspired
focusing on healthy living

The Muslin is our tradition which is
environmentally influenced.

→ ~~গুটি, পাটলা, মটি, মলি~~. Muslin is Bengali
~~cloth~~ Bangladesh is known for Muslin
for its excellent fabric for centuries.
Also, the handloom industry accumulated
livelihood for all communities. Including

Hindu, Muslim indigenous people

Folklores and myths also reflecting the closeness of nature with people. Retirement of ordinary farmers or saint looking some peace and quite goes to forest for meditation — Bonoprash. On the other hand Bonobash means exile or punishment, is also very common in fairytales & folklores. Another example that faith practice also ~~salle~~ closely connected to nature. Ex — Villagers visit Sundarbhan to collect timber and honey. They take 'Grunin' with them. He continuously recites 'Tantra Mantra' while travelling Sundarbhan praying for protection to 'Bonobibi'. Most hatts and bazars are commonly located near some kind of water bodies for the benefits of transportation. Houses are made out of bamboo, mud, straw etc. Houses have less ventilation, lower rooftop & smaller windows

and doors. Since families live together houses are made to the privacy to the female members.

Ans-1

i) structural history, ii) geological setting
iii) geographical location iv) rivers of Bengal
v) climate conditions or seasonal cycles
and vi) contacts, and communication routes
between Bengal and Beyond.

(i) → Thousands of year, Bengal was under water due to movement of tectonic plates - the Indian plate presses against the African and Eurasian plate. And new land emerges and water recedes southwards. Varendra, Madhyapur, Lalmai-Mainamati, Burdwan, Bankura, Murshidabad and the other

sandy, red in color,
rough land

laterite land of Bengal have also emerged through this process.

11) - Old Alluvium Land - Rajmahal, Sarthal Parganas, Manbhum - Singbhum Dhalbhaum comprise this old alluvial land. The highly laterite region of Midnapore - Bankura - Birbhum and Murshidabad belongs to this, Rangpur, Bogura, Rajshahi, Barendia, Madhupurgan North of Dhaka.

Except for -

2. The Comparative New Alluvium land - except for CTG & Tripura rest of the East Bengal drenched with water of Ganges, Padma, Brahmaputra and their tributaries formation of fertile land.

v) → weather is hot and humid. Tropic of Cancer went through Bengal making the weather extremely hot and humid. Heavy rainfall because of the water vapor. Natural

disasters cyclone, flood, high tide, Kalboishakhi and windstorm etc. Himalaya plays a vital role for the monsoonal climate.

vi) → Bengal is naturally isolated, but there are some historically significant contacts & communication routes between the ~~front~~^{world} and beyond. North Bengal → Varanasi → Ayodhya → Pataliputra and Bodhgaya. East of Bengal → Assam → China → Tibet. Chittagong → Araka → Southern Burma. Chittagong port → Samandar in Arab accounts.